

Communication

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Chapter 4: four ideas to connect

Communication process

Account for words, tone, body language, environment, culture, and feedback.

Therapeutic communication

Use active listening, open questions, clarification, reflection, empathy, and appropriate silence.

Barriers

Adapt when pain, anxiety, language, sensory changes, assumptions, or medical jargon interfere.

Team and patient focus

Share clear, relevant information while including the patient and confirming understanding.

Put the chapter into safe practical nursing care

Good communication is measured by understanding—not by speaking.

Listen before responding, use plain language, and ask the patient to explain key information back. Use a qualified interpreter for important communication and ISBAR for focused team reporting.

- ✓ Introduce yourself and listen
- ✓ Use plain language
- ✓ Ask open questions
- ✓ Confirm with teach-back
- ✓ Report with ISBAR

RECOGNIZE → ACT → REPORT

**Listen for meaning.
Confirm understanding.
Share what matters.**

Before moving on, explain the cue, your immediate action within scope, and the facts you would report.